

Legal Case & Document Management System

Complete MVP Features & Functional Specification

Super Admin • Law Firm • Attorney • Paralegal • Staff • Client

Prepared from the finalized 2-week Laravel MVP scope

Technology Foundation: Laravel 13 • PHP 8.3+ • MySQL 8 • Blade + Livewire • Alpine.js •
Tailwind CSS • Google Calendar • Google Drive

1. System-Wide Information Architecture

The application is matter-centric. The Matter/Case is the primary legal workspace and connects the client, parties, documents, communications, tasks, notes, calendar events and activity history.

```
Law Firm
■■■ Users: Attorneys, Paralegals, Legal Assistants, Staff
■■■ Clients
■■■ Matters / Cases
■■■ Case Information
■■■ Parties
■■■ Documents / Versions
■■■ Document Requests / Sharing
■■■ Communications
■■■ Tasks / Todos
■■■ Notes
■■■ Calendar
■■■ Activity / Audit
```

Common identification fields should include id, uuid, firm_id, matter_id where applicable, created_by, updated_by, created_at, updated_at and deleted_at where soft deletion is appropriate.

2. Super Admin Module

Super Admin Dashboard

- Total law firms, active/suspended/inactive firms
- Total attorneys, staff, paralegals and clients
- Total, open, closed and archived matters
- Documents stored and recent upload activity
- Active users, pending invitations and login activity
- Platform-level charts for firms, users, matters and documents

Law Firm Management

- Firm ID / UUID
- Firm name, legal business name, DBA/trade name
- Firm registration / tax details where applicable
- Bar association / registration details
- Practice areas and firm type
- Primary contact, email, phone, website
- Address, city, state, country and postal code
- Timezone, date format, currency and matter numbering format
- Logo, branding and notification/email settings

Firm status: Trial, Active, Suspended, Inactive, Closed.

Super Admin User Management

- User ID / UUID, first/middle/last name and display name
- Email, mobile, username and profile photo
- Firm, role, job title and status
- Last login, email verification and MFA status
- Create/edit/activate/deactivate/suspend users

- Password reset, invitation resend and force logout
- Login history

Role & Permission Management

Use granular RBAC with Laravel Policies/Gates. Example permissions include `matter.view`, `matter.create`, `matter.edit`, `matter.close`, `document.view`, `document.upload`, `document.download`, `document.delete`, `document.share`, `document.request`, `message.view`, `message.send`, `task.view`, `task.create`, `task.assign`, `task.complete`, `note.view`, `note.create`, `calendar.view` and `client.view`.

Platform Audit Logs

- Audit ID, user, firm, action, module, entity and entity ID
- IP address, user agent and timestamp
- Previous value, new value and description
- Login, create, update, delete, upload, download, share, assignment and permission events

3. Law Firm Administration

Firm Dashboard

- Active/new/closed matters
- Matters requiring attention
- Overdue tasks
- Pending document requests
- Recent client activity and documents
- Upcoming deadlines and hearings
- Unread messages

Internal User Management

- First/last name, email, phone, role, job title
- Attorney bar number, jurisdiction and admission date
- Practice areas, department, office location and timezone
- Profile photo and account status
- Roles: Managing Attorney, Attorney, Associate, Paralegal, Legal Assistant, Staff

4. Client Management

Client Types

- Individual
- Business / Organization
- Government Entity
- Estate / Trust
- Other

Individual Client Fields

- Client ID / Client Number

- First, middle, last and preferred name
- Date of birth and occupation
- Primary/secondary email and phone numbers
- Preferred communication method
- Residential/mailling address
- Client status, client type and referral source
- Conflict-check status, intake status, preferred attorney and assigned paralegal

Client status: Lead, Intake, Conflict Check, Prospective, Active, Inactive, Former Client, Archived.

Corporate / Organization Client

- Legal business name, DBA and entity type
- Registration number and tax ID where applicable
- Industry and website
- Primary contact and authorized representative
- Registered and mailing addresses
- Billing and legal contacts

5. Conflict Check

Provide a structured conflict-check record to help identify potential conflicts involving clients, former clients, opposing parties, related parties, witnesses, companies and organizations.

- Conflict Check ID, matter, client, checked by/date
- Search terms and result
- Conflict identified and description
- Resolution, reviewer and review date

Status: Pending, Clear, Potential Conflict, Conflict Identified, Waiver Required, Cleared by Attorney, Rejected.

6. Matter / Case Management

The Matter is the heart of the system. Firms may display 'Case' in the interface, but the underlying concept should remain a Matter.

Matter Identification

- Matter ID / UUID / Matter Number
- Matter Name and Short Matter Name
- Client
- Matter Type and Practice Area
- Responsible / Supervising Attorney
- Assigned Paralegal / Staff
- Open Date, Close Date and Status
- Description, priority and team

Legal Details

- Court Name and Court Type

- Jurisdiction, county and state
- Case Number / Docket Number
- Judge / Magistrate / Judicial Officer
- Filing Date, Hearing Date and Trial Date
- Statute / Rule References

Recommended matter statuses: Prospective, Intake, Conflict Check, Open, Active, Pending, On Hold, Settled, Resolved, Closed, Archived.

Matter Types / Practice Areas

- Civil Litigation, Criminal, Family Law, Employment, Personal Injury, Medical Malpractice
- Commercial Litigation, Real Estate Litigation
- Contracts, Corporate, M&A, Real Estate Transactions, Estate Planning
- Immigration, Tax, Bankruptcy, Regulatory, Probate, Insurance and other firm-defined types

7. Parties Module

- Party ID and Party Type
- Entity Type, name and contact information
- Address, attorney and law firm
- Role and relationship to the matter
- Notes

Party types can include Plaintiff, Defendant, Petitioner, Respondent, Appellant, Appellee, Claimant, Opposing Party, Witness, Third Party, Interested Party, Government Agency, Insurer, Employer, Creditor and Debtor.

8. Matter Team

- Lead Attorney
- Supervising Attorney
- Associate
- Paralegal
- Legal Assistant
- Case Manager
- Staff

Store user, matter role, access level, assignment date, removal date and active/inactive status.

9. Document Management

Documents are matter-centric and private by default.

Document Fields

- Document ID / UUID / Document Number
- File Name and Document Title
- Document Type, Category and Subcategory
- Matter and Client

- Uploaded By, Created Date and Uploaded Date
- Tags, confidentiality, visibility and document status

Legal Document Types

- Pleading, Motion, Brief, Order, Judgment
- Contract, Agreement, Correspondence
- Discovery, Deposition, Evidence, Exhibit
- Affidavit, Declaration, Court Filing, Notice
- Legal Research, Memorandum, Client Document
- Financial Document, Medical Record, Photograph, Other

Document Tags

- confidential, privileged, work-product, discovery, evidence, court-filing
- client-provided, opposing-counsel, draft, final, urgent, hearing
- settlement, contract, deposition, review-required, follow-up

Visibility & Confidentiality

- Visibility: Internal Only, Attorney Only, Legal Team, Client Visible, Specific Users, Specific Client, Restricted
- Classification: Public, Internal, Confidential, Highly Confidential, Attorney-Client Privileged, Attorney Work Product

These are classification labels and should not be treated as a legal determination merely because a user selected a label.

10. Document Version Control

- Version number, document ID and stored file
- Uploaded by/date
- Change description
- Version status and previous/current version relationship

Typical sequence: Draft v1 → Draft v2 → Review v3 → Final → Executed, as appropriate.

11. Document Requests

- Request ID, matter, client and requester
- Document type, request title and description
- Due date, priority and status
- Requested/completed dates

Status: Draft, Sent, Viewed, Partially Completed, Submitted, Under Review, Accepted, Rejected, Overdue, Cancelled.

12. Document Sharing

- Document, shared with/by, share type
- Expiration date
- View/download permissions
- Message and shared date

13. Mobile Camera Capture

Responsive clients and staff can open a matter, select Documents, capture a document using the device camera, preview it, retake it if necessary, confirm and upload it. Support JPG, JPEG, PNG and PDF uploads.

14. Client Portal

Client Dashboard

- Active matters
- Recent documents
- Pending document requests
- Upcoming events
- Recent messages
- Tasks requiring client action
- Notifications

Client Matter View

- Overview: matter name/number/status, responsible attorney, assigned team and description
- Tabs: Overview, Documents, Requests, Messages, Tasks, Calendar, permitted Notes and limited client-safe Activity

Clients may only access their own matters and resources explicitly authorized for client visibility.

15. Client Communication

- Matter-based message threads
- Message ID, thread, sender, recipient, subject and body
- Attachments, sent date, read date and status
- Thread types: Client Communication, Document Request, General Matter Communication

Internal communications must be technically separated through database authorization, not merely hidden in the UI.

16. Attorney Module

- My Matters
- Matters Requiring Attention
- Upcoming Hearings
- Upcoming Deadlines
- Overdue Tasks
- Pending Client Documents
- Unread Client Messages
- Recent Matter Activity and Documents

Attorney Matter Workspace: Overview, Parties, Team, Documents, Requests, Messages, Tasks, Notes, Calendar, Activity and Settings.

17. Notes

Support two visibility levels: Internal Notes and Client-Visible Notes.

- Note ID, matter, title and body
- Note type, visibility, creator/updater and timestamps

- Tags

Note types: Case Note, Client Note, Legal Research, Strategy, Meeting Note, Telephone Note, Interview Note, Internal Note, Follow-up.

18. Task Management

- Task ID, matter, title and description
- Assigned to, created by, priority and status
- Start date, due date and completed date
- Tags and related document/client/party

Status: Not Started, In Progress, Waiting, Blocked, Completed, Cancelled. Priority: Low, Normal, High, Urgent, Critical.

19. Legal Deadlines

Distinguish court-imposed deadlines from ordinary internal work items.

- Deadline type, due date/time
- Court Deadline, Filing Deadline, Response Deadline
- Discovery Deadline, Hearing Deadline, Internal Deadline
- Reminder date

This distinction is important for legal workflow and reporting.

20. Personal Todo List

- Todo title and description
- Priority, due date and status
- Category, reminder and completed date

Categories: Personal, Follow-up, Call, Email, Review, Research, Administrative.

21. Calendar

- Court Hearing, Trial, Deposition, Client Meeting
- Attorney Meeting, Mediation, Arbitration
- Filing Deadline, Consultation, Conference
- Internal Meeting and Reminder

Event fields: event ID, matter, title, description, start/end date/time, location, virtual meeting URL, event type, assigned users, reminders and status.

22. Google Calendar Integration

- OAuth 2.0 connection
- Connect Google account and select calendar
- Import events
- Create/update/delete synced events
- Store external event ID and synchronization status
- Last synchronized timestamp

For the 2-week MVP, keep synchronization controlled and avoid attempting to reproduce every Google Calendar feature.

23. Google Drive Integration

- OAuth connection and connection status
- Create or link a matter folder
- View/import files
- Upload/export files
- Store external Drive file ID and URL
- Track synchronization

Advanced two-way Drive synchronization should remain outside the MVP unless there is sufficient time.

24. Analytics

Matter Analytics

- Total/open/closed matters
- Matters by practice area, attorney and status
- New and closed matters by month

Document Analytics

- Documents uploaded
- Documents by type/matter/user
- Client-uploaded documents
- Pending document requests

Productivity Analytics

- Tasks completed
- Overdue tasks
- Tasks by attorney/paralegal/status

Client Activity

- Active clients
- Portal logins
- Document uploads/downloads
- Messages and outstanding requests

25. Global Search

- Search Clients, Matters, Documents, Parties, Messages, Tasks, Notes and Calendar Events
- Filters: client, matter, matter number, document, document type/category, attorney, paralegal, status, tag and date
- Search should support names, matter numbers, document titles and other indexed metadata

Critical security rule: search results must be authorization-aware. A user must never discover a record through search that they cannot otherwise access.

26. Paralegal Module

- Assigned Matters dashboard
- Open and overdue tasks
- Pending client documents
- Upcoming deadlines and hearings
- Recent documents and unread messages
- Upload and organize documents
- Create document requests
- Communicate with clients where permitted
- Create/update tasks
- Add internal notes
- Maintain permitted matter metadata and calendar information

27. Legal Assistant / Staff Module

- View assigned matters
- Update administrative matter fields
- Upload documents and manage metadata
- Schedule events
- Create tasks and manage todos
- Communicate with clients where permitted

By default, staff should not have unrestricted access to privileged attorney notes, security settings, user permissions or matter closure.

28. Matter Activity / Case Chronology

Provide a chronological matter timeline that records important events.

- Matter created
- Document uploaded/viewed/downloaded/shared
- Message sent
- Task created/completed
- Note added
- Status changed
- Client activity
- Calendar event
- Assignment changed

Example chronology: Client uploaded medical records → Attorney reviewed documents → Complaint drafted → Complaint filed → Hearing scheduled.

29. Notifications

- New document uploaded
- Document request received/overdue
- New client message

- Task assigned/due/overdue
- Upcoming calendar event
- Matter assignment
- Matter status change

Support both in-app and email notifications.

30. Notification Preferences

- Email notifications
- In-app notifications
- Task notifications
- Document notifications
- Message notifications
- Calendar reminders
- Matter notifications

31. Tag Management

Allow firms to maintain their own tag library. Tags may be attached to Clients, Matters, Documents, Tasks, Notes and Messages.

- Examples: urgent, confidential, priority, court, hearing, discovery, settlement, client-document, draft, final, review-required, follow-up

32. Custom Fields

Architect custom fields into the platform even if only a limited implementation is exposed in the MVP.

- Text
- Long Text
- Number
- Currency
- Date
- Date & Time
- Boolean
- Dropdown
- Multi-select
- Email
- Phone
- URL

Example matter custom fields: Insurance Carrier, Claim Number, Policy Number, Accident Date.

33. Document Category Taxonomy

- Pleadings
 - Complaint
 - Answer
 - Motion

- Brief
- Discovery
- Interrogatories
- Requests for Production
- Responses
- Depositions
- Evidence
- Photographs
- Medical Records
- Contracts
- Exhibits
- Correspondence
- Client
- Opposing Counsel
- Court
- Court
- Orders
- Notices
- Filings

34. Security & Access Control

Authorization should follow a layered hierarchy: Firm Access → Role Permission → Matter Assignment → Resource Permission → Document Visibility.

- Use Laravel Policies/Gates for authorization
- Keep documents private by default
- Serve protected documents through authorized application routes
- Do not expose sensitive files through public URLs
- Audit important access and modification events
- Apply firm-level and matter-level scoping consistently

35. Attorney / Paralegal / Staff / Client Access Matrix

Feature	Attorney	Paralegal	Staff	Client
View assigned matters	Yes	Yes	Yes	Own only
Create matter	Yes	Optional	Optional	No
Close matter	Yes	No	No	No
Upload documents	Yes	Yes	Yes	Own portal
Delete documents	Yes	Limited	Limited	No
Share documents	Yes	Yes	Optional	No
Internal notes	Yes	Yes	Limited	No
Client-visible notes	Yes	Yes	Optional	View
Client messages	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Assign tasks	Yes	Yes	Optional	No
Calendar	Yes	Yes	Yes	Limited
Google Calendar	Yes	Yes	Optional	No
Google Drive	Yes	Yes	Optional	No
Analytics	Yes	Limited	Limited	Own activity
User management	Admin	No	No	No
Permissions	Admin	No	No	No

36. Client Access Model

Client access should follow: Client → Client User → Client's Matters → Client-visible resources.

- Clients cannot access other clients
- Clients cannot access internal notes or internal chat
- Clients cannot access attorney-only/restricted documents
- Clients cannot access internal tasks or internal audit logs

37. Identification Standards

- Database IDs: id plus UUID
- Firm ID: firm_id
- Matter relationship: matter_id
- Client relationship: client_id
- Creator/updater: created_by / updated_by
- Human-readable identifiers: CLI-000001, MAT-2026-000001, DOC-2026-000001, TSK-2026-000001

Use UUIDs externally where appropriate instead of exposing sequential database IDs.

38. Standard Status Taxonomy

- Matter: Prospective, Intake, Conflict Check, Open, Active, Pending, On Hold, Settled, Resolved, Closed, Archived
- Document: Draft, Under Review, Final, Executed, Archived
- Task: Not Started, In Progress, Waiting, Blocked, Completed, Cancelled
- Request: Draft, Sent, Viewed, Submitted, Under Review, Accepted, Rejected, Overdue, Cancelled

39. Recommended Laravel Architecture

```
app/  
  Actions/  
  Console/  
  Enums/  
  Events/  
  Exceptions/  
  Http/  
  Controllers/  
  Requests/  
  Middleware/  
  Livewire/  
  Models/  
  Notifications/  
  Policies/  
  Services/  
  Documents/  
  Matters/  
  Clients/  
  Calendar/  
  Google/  
  Drive/  
  Search/  
  Analytics/  
  Support/
```

- Modular Laravel monolith
- Thin controllers; business logic in Actions/Services
- Form Requests for validation

- Policies for authorization
- Jobs for asynchronous operations
- Notifications for email/in-app delivery
- Google integrations isolated under service classes
- Firm-scoped business records and matter-scoped resources

40. Core Database Tables

```
firms
users
roles
permissions
role_user
permission_role
clients
client_contacts
client_addresses
matters
matter_users
matter_parties
parties
document_categories
documents
document_versions
document_shares
document_requests
document_tags
tags
message_threads
messages
message_attachments
tasks
task_comments
todos
notes
calendar_events
google_calendar_connections
google_calendar_events
google_drive_connections
google_drive_files
notifications
audit_logs
custom_fields
custom_field_values
```

41. Final Navigation

Super Admin

Dashboard • Law Firms • Users • Roles & Permissions • Platform Analytics • Audit Logs • Settings

Law Firm / Attorney / Paralegal / Staff

Dashboard • Clients • Matters • Documents • Document Requests • Messages • Tasks • My Todos • Notes • Calendar • Google Calendar • Google Drive • Search • Analytics • Notifications • Activity • Profile • Settings

Client

Dashboard • My Matters • Documents • Document Requests • Messages • Tasks • Calendar • Notifications • Profile

42. MVP Priority

P0 — Must Have

- Authentication and RBAC
- Law firms, users, clients, matters, parties and matter teams
- Documents, categories, tags, versioning, requests and secure sharing
- Client portal
- Matter chat
- Tasks, notes and todos
- Calendar and Google Calendar
- Google Drive
- Search
- Notifications
- Audit logs
- Responsive UI and camera upload
- Basic analytics

P1 — If Time Permits

- Custom fields
- Advanced matter chronology
- Advanced dashboard filters
- Advanced calendar recurrence
- Advanced document sharing
- Additional reporting

P2 — Future

- OCR, AI legal assistant, AI document analysis, e-signature, payments, SMS
- Native mobile apps
- Advanced accounting/billing/time tracking/trust accounting
- Advanced two-way Drive synchronization
- Elasticsearch/OpenSearch
- Workflow automation
- Court/e-filing integrations
- External legal research integrations

43. Recommended Product Principle

Do not build separate applications for Attorney, Paralegal, Staff and Client. Build one Laravel application with role-based experiences. The UI and permissions change by role while the underlying matter, document, communication, task, note and audit engines remain shared.

The Matter Workspace should be the central user experience so that opening a matter immediately exposes its overview, parties, team, documents, messages, tasks, notes, calendar and activity.

44. Engineering Completion Standard

A feature should not be considered complete merely because its screen works. Each feature is complete only when its database model/migration, validation, authorization, business logic, UI, responsive behavior, error handling, audit

requirements, tests and documentation are addressed.

This specification is intended to serve as the master functional baseline for the two-week MVP and as the source of truth for AI-assisted implementation using Claude/ChatGPT.

Explicitly excluded from the current MVP: OCR, AI, SMS, payments, CMMI requirements, e-signatures, native apps, microservices and advanced search infrastructure.